



Air assistance

Chinook heavy-lift helicopters belonging to the Vietnam Air Force take part in the movement of people and supplies out of Xuan Loc during the evacuation of the city. The South Vietnamese were able to hold out for a fortnight against overwhelmingly superior forces.

“I don’t care **how many** divisions **the other side** sends against me ... I will **knock them down!**”

GENERAL LE MINH DAO, ARVN COMMANDER AT XUAN LOC, TV INTERVIEW, APRIL 1975

» AFTER

The fall of Xuan Loc left Saigon indefensible, but how the North Vietnamese would choose to end the war remained uncertain.

NORTH VIETNAM TAKES CONTROL

Political leaders in Saigon hoped for a **negotiated end** to the conflict that would stop short of a total communist takeover, but the NVA **struck Saigon directly**. The United States belatedly organized a **final evacuation** of its staff and selected Vietnamese. Left behind, many of the heroes of Xuan Loc ended up in **communist re-education camps**.